

Problem 3: Singing it in Tlingit

(25 marks)

Given below are 21 phrases in Tlingit³ and their corresponding English translations *in arbitrary order*. Note that capitalized words in both languages are proper nouns, but not all proper nouns in Tlingit may be capitalized.⁴

A. lingit'aaní	i. around the outside of a house
B. daaká.hít	ii. someone's footprint
C. dáanaa s'aatí	iii. spring
D. dáanaa yéilaa	iv. roofing paper
E. <u>G</u> agaan Hít	v. rich person
F. gagaan wak <u>d</u> áana	vi. descendants of Raven
G. gagaan <u>x</u> 'us.eetí	vii. sunglasses
H. hít s'aatí	viii. sunlight
I. héen <u>x</u> 'aká	ix. clan leader
J. <u>k</u> aa s'aatí	x. Raven House
K. <u>k</u> aa <u>x</u> 'us.eetí	xi. Milky Way
L. Lqlaya'k' <u>x</u> 'us.eetí	xii. Sun House
M. Lqlaya'k'. <u>x</u> 'ahéeni	xiii. Winter Village
N. tàakw.àani	xiv. the world
O. tàakw.eeti	xv. envelope
P. hít kax'úx'u	xvi. Lk'ayáak'w's saliva
Q. <u>x</u> 'a	xvii. on the mouth of the water
R. x'úx' daakáx'úx'	xviii. Halloween mask
S. Yéil Hít	xix. counterfeit money
T. yéil.eetí <u>k</u> aa	xx. someone's boss
U. yéilaa	xxi. mouth

Assignment 1: (15 marks)

Determine the correct correspondences.

Assignment 2: (2 marks)

What does Lqlaya'k! x'us.eetí literally mean?

³The Tlingit language is a branch of the Na-Dene language family and is spoken by approximately 500 people in southeastern Alaska and western Canada.

⁴é, ú, í, and á are vowels; . is a glottal stop (like the sound in "uh-oh"); ! is a click consonant; x, k, and g are other consonants; and ' after a consonant indicates it is ejective, i.e. produced with a burst of air from the back of the throat.

Raven House, Sun House, and On The Water House are the names of Tlingit clans. Winter Village is the Tlingit name for Metlakatla, Annette Island. In Tlingit mythology, Raven is the creator god, described as being both a person and a raven and known as a cunning trickster. Lk'ayáak'w was a hero who chased Dry Cloud, a mythical being, for months, until they both fled up into the skies and could no longer return. A Halloween mask is a mask worn during the festival of Halloween, with the aim of concealing one's identity.

Assignment 3: (4 marks)

Translate the following Tlingit phrases literally into English. Their meanings are provided for reference.

(a) wax'ahéeni, "tears"

(b) kaa x'a.eetí, "leftover food"

Assignment 4: (4 marks)

Translate into Tlingit: (a) mayor; (b) On The Water House.

– Pratyush Vempati
